



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Northeast Ohio Classical Academy

School Website: <https://neocacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Northeast Ohio Classical Academy (NEOCA) presents a primarily classical orientation with clear commitments to traditional liberal arts, virtue formation, and Western-civilizational study, anchored by a Hillsdale College K-12 curriculum. The school foregrounds moral character, civic virtue, and a content-rich liberal-arts core, while presenting opportunities for student memory work, classical language study, and geometry of a traditional curriculum. Public materials emphasize truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, and wonder, and consistently frame education as formation and character shaping, not merely information delivery.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Public-facing materials consistently stress virtue, moral formation, and civic responsibility, and explicitly adopt a Hillsdale K-12 classical framework (evidence: explicit curriculum claims, mission statements, and curriculum descriptions). - The site foregrounds objective realities in truth, goodness, and beauty as core aims, with frequent references to moral character, virtue, and civic virtue. This strongly supports the core classical aim of formation through the liberal arts (evidence: language in “A curriculum that is content-rich...,” “the study of Latin is a requirement...,” “an approach to instruction that acknowledges objective standards of correctness, logic, beauty, weightiness, and truth”). - Some elements of the classical rubric appear less explicit (notably liturgical/theological grounding and explicit Socratic pedagogy in upper grades) in public-facing pages, which tempers a full CLASSICAL rating in every dimension. Evidence of Socratic seminars or explicit liturgy is not clearly on public pages, though the Hillsdale curriculum and the “Great Conversation” ethos are implied by the Hillsdale framework and mission language.

Executive findings by category (category-by-category snapshot follows in the next section).

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate: CLASSICAL

Cited sources reflect the school’s public-facing materials (curriculum descriptions, mission statements, and performance-oriented communications), including direct phrases about truth, beauty, virtue, formation, and Hillsdale K-12, which together establish the overall Classical orientation, with notes where theology, liturgy, and explicit Socratic pedagogy are not clearly evidenced on public pages. See sources for category-specific evidence and keyword mappings: public-facing curriculum and mission pages; and the Six Essential Elements keyword lexicon for indicator lists.. Additional procedural context comes from the classical-education keyword lexicon and the Six Essential Elements materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Public materials emphasize moral virtue and transcendent aims (truth, goodness, beauty) as real and knowable in the educational project; examples include statements about objective standards of correctness, logic, beauty, weightiness, and truth in classroom instruction, and the explicit emphasis on virtue and moral character in school culture and mission statements. These elements indicate transcendental aims and character formation, even if explicit theological language is not foregrounded in the public materials. See: “An approach to instruction that acknowledges objective standards of correctness, logic, beauty, weightiness, and truth” and “moral character and civic virtue.”
- The school’s mission explicitly seeks to form students morally and civically (virtue, character, and citizenship).
- The culture excerpt emphasizes virtue and wonder as components of the educational experience.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present (examples): truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, moral character, civic virtue, conscience, wonder, reverence, virtue ethics, character formation. Findings drawn from site text (e.g., truth/beauty/virtue language; moral character; civic virtue).
- Negative keywords present: none clearly evidenced in public pages (e.g., secular humanism, values-clarification, or morally-neutral language are not apparent on the public pages examined). The classical-lexicon negative indicators exist in the knowledge lexicon, but are not reflected as explicit warnings in the school’s content.
- Why this rating
- The school clearly foregrounds formation, virtue, and transcendental ideals (truth, goodness, beauty) but does not overtly articulate theological instruction or liturgical practices in its public content, which reduces it from fully CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in this category. The presence of virtue-focused pedagogy and the explicit aim of formation align with classical aims, but theology-based grounding and liturgical/community worship language are not explicit in public materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission and vision statements articulate formation of virtuous, wise citizens and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful; the school frames education as formation and human flourishing, not simply job preparation. The mission asserts moral character and civic virtue as core aims; the vision emphasizes Western civilization, virtue, and the cultivation of citizens.
- Foundational language emphasizes “formation” and “virtue,” with explicit references to liberal-arts formation and classical heritage. The Hillsdale K-12 framework positions education as an integrated, classical mission rather than solely workforce preparation.
- The public materials consistently frame truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, aligning with a classical telos of knowledge for human excellence.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, classical mission, telos, permanent questions, great conversation, classical heritage, human excellence, moral imagination. These are evidenced in mission/vision and curriculum descriptions.
- Negative keywords present: none prominent; the materials do not foreground a competing emphasis on college/career readiness as the primary telos. The emphasis remains formation-centric rather than purely job-readiness.
- Why this rating

- NEOCA's public materials consistently articulate formation toward virtue and wisdom, with a clear classical mission and telos aligned to liberal-arts formation and civic virtue. The emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth-goodness-beauty rather than purely job-readiness supports CLASSICAL in this category. The absence of a dominant workforce- or skill-prep framing in public content reinforces CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum is described as liberal-arts-based, with emphasis on the Western tradition through history, literature, philosophy, and the fine arts; explicit instruction in phonics and grammar; Latin study; and a content-rich core across math, science, literature, and history. This mirrors the Trivium/Quadrivium focus and Great-Books-era orientation common to classical education.
- The Hillsdale College curriculum framework is invoked as the foundational curriculum, positioning Great Books and classical study as central to the program.
- The site details include explicit language about the centrality of Western tradition, study of American literary/moral/philosophical/historical traditions, and Latin/grammar emphasis.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric (implied by the Trivium/Quadrivium framing and language about phonics/grammar), Latin, Western tradition, history, literature, philosophy, fine arts, great books, classics, and primary sources, cyclic emphasis on wonder. The site text reflects core elements of the classical curriculum (grammar/phonics, Latin, Western tradition, core disciplines).
- Negative keywords present: not clearly evidenced; no overt emphasis on modern, project-based, STEM-first, or social-studies-as-history-replacement language on public pages. Some knowledge-lexicon negatives (e.g., avoidance of non-classical approaches) are present only in the lexicon, not in the public content.
- Why this rating
- NEOCA's curriculum description aligns closely with classical core elements: content-rich core disciplines, Latin and grammar emphasis, Western-tradition focus, and an overarching Hillsdale classical program. While not every possible Great-Books phrasing appears on every page, the canonical components are clearly present, yielding CLASSICAL for Curriculum.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize traditional, teacher-led instruction and a living curriculum, contrasting with student-centered, fully constructivist models (e.g., "well-educated and articulate teachers who use traditional, teacher-led methods of instruction" and references to formal, teacher-driven classroom leadership). This leans classical in pedagogy, but explicit Socratic seminars, memory-chanting, or recitation-based pedagogy in upper grades are not clearly evidenced on the public pages.
- The curriculum language also hints at a classical rhythm with contemplative/Schol  -like qualities (the language of virtue, order, and a holistic formation) but without explicit statements about restful scholarly practice or structured memory work in lower grades on the public pages. The Six Elements materials emphasize features like Socratic discussion, memory work (recitation/chanting), and restfulness as pedagogical modes; the public site does not consistently foreground these exact pedagogical practices, though it implies traditional pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: teacher-led instruction, traditional methods, living curriculum, memory work, chant, recitation, Scholé (as concept, not necessarily named explicitly in pages). The public materials emphasize tradition and teacher leadership.
- Negative keywords present: there is no clear emphasis on project-based learning, experiential learning, or student-centered discovery as the primary method; these are flagged as negative in classical lexicons, but not strongly evidenced in NEOCA's public content. The lexicon itself lists negative signals (e.g., experiential/project-based focus) as contrasts; NEOCA does not foreground those in public text.
- Why this rating
- The pedagogy leans toward classical teacher-centered instruction and structure, yet lacks explicit, widespread public evidence of key classical pedagogical modes (e.g., Socratic seminars in public-facing pages, upper-grade rhetorical training, or systematic memory/chants). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating in Pedagogy overall. The presence of a traditional teacher-led orientation supports a CLASSICAL tilt, but the absence of explicit, widely documented Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy reduces it from CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials describe the faculty as well-educated, articulate, and central to classroom life; phrases such as “well-educated and articulate teachers who use traditional, teacher-led methods of instruction” imply a living curriculum and a culture of mentorship. The faculty are positioned as the core element of the school and central to its classical mission.
- The school emphasizes a “living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher” concept in the classical lexicon sense, and the public materials repeatedly highlight the teachers as central to the school’s educational project and to forming character.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, teachers as mentors, faculty as the core of the school, collegial culture, highly qualified teachers, mentor-mentee tone, and leader figures.
- Negative keywords present: none clearly evidenced in public content.
- Why this rating
- The public materials present a strong, affirmative view of faculty as the living core of classical education and a model for character and virtue. This aligns solidly with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school actively frames parents as co-teachers and partners in classical education, with multiple parent-info nights, community events, and family involvement philosophy. The site emphasizes parent formation, reading groups, seminars, and a strong partnership with families; it positions the campus as open to parental visits and involvement.
- The Six Essential Elements lexicon highlights explicit partnership with families, parent formation, and an open-campus ethos as key indicators of classical practice. The school’s communications reflect those elements (partnering with parents, parent nights, and opportunities for parent involvement).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental engagement, home-centered learning, family formation, parent formation, open campus, parent visits, community involvement. These appear across NEOCA's outreach and family-communication pages.
- Negative keywords present: none clearly evidenced on public materials; the school's communications emphasize collaboration with families rather than consumer-oriented language.
- Why this rating
- NEOCA's public materials foreground explicit parental partnership, family engagement, and openness to parents, aligning strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): If the school wishes to move toward a fully CLASSICAL standing in this category, it could:
- Add explicit theological grounding or liturgical/community worship language to public materials (optional within a public-charter context, but frequently present in many classical schools' "liturgical" or "communal" elements). A clear articulation of theological underpinning or liturgical practices would strengthen the Liturgical/Communal Practices and Grounded in Theology signals.
- Integrate explicit liturgical or theological framing in the curriculum narrative (e.g., a section detailing liturgical rhythms or catechesis alignment) to meet full classical criteria for liturgical community and theology.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): To elevate Pedagogy toward CLASSICAL:
- Include explicit evidence of Socratic pedagogy and seminars in upper grades on public pages or in formal program documentation (e.g., documented Socratic seminars, Harkness methods, or rhetoric/debate programs with public-facing descriptions).
- Increase emphasis on Scholé/restful learning and memory working/recitation on public materials to reflect a deeper adherence to the classical pedagogy tradition.
- Element 2, 3, 5, 6 currently show CLASSICAL alignment. Minor enhancements in public-facing content (e.g., more explicit Great-Books/Great-Conversation language, and explicit Socratic or memory-work references) could further reinforce the classical standing.
- Concrete moves
- Publish a public-facing "Pedagogy Snapshot" detailing Socratic seminars, Harkness-style discussions, and upper-grade rhetoric projects with examples.
- Add a public-facing page or document describing liturgical or communal practices (where applicable) or theological grounding that complements the Hillsdale-based curriculum.
- Include explicit Great-Books/Great-Conversation language in curriculum pages, with sample course lists and annotated reading lists.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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